



Engineer's Choice (Courtesy: Poll conducted by EFY at different social networking sites)

doors and windows, mess around with robotics and sense temperature using the Gertboard (a board that plugs into the Raspberry Pi and enables you to interface your Pi with other devices).

If you want something more serious, check out the DoodleBorg—a three-horse-power robot made available from PiBorg. They have a lot of other add-on boards available for the Pi, mostly targeting robotic applications. Their collection includes motion and direction sensors, motor controllers and an LED board that they call LEDBorg. Apart from these cool accessories, PiBorg gets brownie points from us, as their name is an offshoot of the amazing Borg civilisa-

tion from Star Trek!

See the Pi. The possibilities available for a Raspberry Pi that can observe visual images are amazing. While previous tinkerers and hackers used webcams to give the power of sight to their Pi, the Raspberry Pi Foundation decided to empower its board's users with their in-house camera board.

Thus the Rpi Camera module was born. With a 5-megapixel sensor on a board, the module is a much-awaited accessory that connects to the Pi via a ribbon cable. While there are many other webcams available that can be connected to the Raspberry Pi via USB, the module launched by the foundation has the benefit of delivering excellent video and imaging quality.

Another interesting module is the Pi NoIR version, which comes in a black PCB and has the IR filter removed from the camera system. What this means is that your Pi can now see near-IR wavelengths, enabling it to

mimic features of a security camera at a much lower cost.

Hear the Pi. Raspberry Pi has certain limitations when it comes to audio. It has an audio peripheral connection which is limited in a number of ways, resulting in the problem that there is no way to capture audio using a Pi alone.

Audio output is limited to two parts—analogue via on-board 3.5mm stereo output jack and digital only via on-board HDMI output. While HDMI provides the potential for high-quality audio rendering, it cannot be used to capture voice. The analogue option gives an output quality that is only decent at best, which cannot be compared with digital quality output.

This creates a necessity for Audio Pi, which has many audio features. It extends the audio output analysis of a Raspberry Pi beyond the HDMI output through its on-board HD codex and processor. It has on-board 24-bit voice processor that users can use with their PC to record the audio events, or to build some kind of a karaoke system with the

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